

Lake Como / Blanca / Ellingwood / Mount Lindsey

Aug 19-25, 2026

Weather is evidence, not permission. Actual conditions govern the decision.

Operational Timeline

APPROACH + CAMP | Aug 22, 2026

Lake Como approach and camp

10:00 AM Lake Como approach planned start

Road clearance, conditions, and driver judgment determine the actual starting point and time.

3:30 PM Lake Como reach-camp planning target

Use this target to preserve recovery margin; reassess actual conditions.

PRIMARY OBJECTIVE | Aug 23, 2026

Blanca Peak + Ellingwood Point

4:15 AM Blanca and Ellingwood planned start

This is the current trip plan. Actual conditions govern the start.

11:30 AM Below-exposed-terrain planning target

User-set target. Reassess weather, terrain, pace, descent time, and group condition.

SEPARATE PLANNED OBJECTIVE | Aug 24, 2026

Mount Lindsey

5:15 AM Mount Lindsey planned start

Current access, route conditions, and group judgment govern the actual climb.

12:00 PM Mount Lindsey return/exit planning target

Reassess access, weather, terrain, pace, and group condition.

Planning targets are not safety cutoffs. Reassess against actual weather, terrain, pace, descent duration, access, and group condition.

Decision Gates

- Compare the saved forecast timestamp with actual sky, wind, and cloud growth at departure.
- At the upper basin, reassess wind, cloud growth, pace, comfort, and group condition.
- Before the Blanca-Ellingwood traverse, reassess weather, rock, time, and every climber's comfort; the traverse remains optional.
- Turn or descend for thunder or rapidly building convection, balance-impairing wind, worsening altitude symptoms, unacceptable rockfall or route conditions, any climber declining the Class 3 traverse, or exposure after the agreed planning target.
- Before leaving service, confirm current Mount Lindsey access and waiver requirements; route conditions and group judgment govern.

Field weather record

Saved weather last refreshed:

Actual sky/wind observed:

Saved weather may be stale. Current conditions are not confirmed by this printed guide.

Route Profile Summary

Schematic comparison - not navigation-grade geometry

LAKE COMO APPROACH AND CAMP

Lake Como Approach from near 8,000 ft

11.25 mi ROUND TRIP | 3,900 ft gain

Class 1 | Low exposure

Gain is published cumulative gain, not endpoint subtraction.

Return consideration: Road clearance determines the actual starting point; do not force the vehicle higher than conditions support.

LAKE COMO APPROACH AND CAMP

Lake Como Approach from near 8,800 ft

8.5 mi ROUND TRIP | 3,100 ft gain

Class 1 | Low exposure

Gain is published cumulative gain, not endpoint subtraction.

Return consideration: Road clearance determines the actual starting point; do not force the vehicle higher than conditions support.

BLANCA PEAK + ELLINGWOOD POINT

Blanca + Ellingwood from Lake Como camp

7 mi ROUND TRIP | 3,000 ft gain

Class 3 | Considerable exposure

Traverse optional - take the Class 3 connecting ridge, or return to the standard trail before reascending.

Return consideration: The traverse remains optional.

Weather, rock, time, and every climber's comfort decide the sequence.

MOUNT LINDSEY

Mount Lindsey - Northwest Gully

8.25 mi ROUND TRIP | 3,500 ft gain

Easy Class 3 | Considerable exposure

Return consideration: Trailhead elevation remains unverified; no net descent figure is shown.

Cumulative gain comparison

Lake Como Approach from near 8,000 ft - 3,900 ft

Lake Como Approach from near 8,800 ft - 3,100 ft

Blanca + Ellingwood from Lake Como camp - 3,000 ft

Mount Lindsey - Northwest Gully - 3,500 ft

Mount Lindsey access

An executed landowner waiver is required to enter Trinchera Blanca Ranch property for the designated Mount Lindsey summit access route.

Scope is hiking access to the summit on the designated route. The portal prohibits route deviation, hunting, camping, overnight use, motorized or wheeled transport, and drones on ranch property; it does not represent the route as maintained or supervised.

Before leaving service, confirm current Mount Lindsey access and waiver requirements; route conditions and group judgment govern.

Possession of this guide does not grant access.

Canonical reference points

Lake Como area | 37.56960, -105.51406 | 11,750 ft

weather/reference point for the Lake Como area; not an exact campsite location.

Blanca Peak | 37.57753, -105.48569 | 14,350 ft

Ellingwood Point | 37.58257, -105.49248 | 14,057 ft

Mount Lindsey | 37.58389, -105.44490 | 14,055 ft

Lily Lake Trailhead: Exact coordinate/elevation is pending verification and is not shown.

Return considerations

Use the known route return represented in each canonical route profile. Do not infer shortcuts, alternate descents, water sources, shelters, or undocumented return options from this summary.

Emergency + Communication

Lake Como / Blanca / Ellingwood / Mount Lindsey

CALL 911 FIRST.

Give: Provide exact location, mountain, route, elevation, and coordinates if available. Provide injuries, party size, weather, and current conditions.

Dispatch determines the responding agency from the exact incident location.

You do not need to choose a county before calling.

Alamosa

County dispatch: 719-589-5807

Sheriff's office: 719-589-6608

Lake Como and the Alamosa-side approach may involve Alamosa County; summit-area incidents may involve Costilla County.

Verified: Aug 7, 2026

Huerfano

County dispatch: 719-738-1044

Sheriff's office: 719-738-1600

Lily Lake and trailhead-side incidents may involve Huerfano County; summit-area incidents may involve Costilla County.

Verified: Aug 7, 2026

Costilla

County dispatch: 719-672-3302

Sheriff's office: 719-672-0673

Summit-area incidents on Blanca Peak, Ellingwood Point, or Mount Lindsey may involve Costilla County; exact incident location controls.

Verified: Aug 7, 2026

Communication field log

Milestone	Time	Status / initials
☐ Vehicle departure		
☐ Lake Como camp		
☐ Summit start		
☐ Summit or high point		
☐ Below exposed terrain		
☐ Back at camp		
☐ Back at vehicle		
☐ Fort Garland		
☐ Home		

Confirm delivery in the sending app before marking an update.

Personal contact

Name:

Phone:

Alternate:

Optional medical / personal notes

Complete by hand after printing.

Weather / staleness

Saved weather last refreshed:

Actual sky/wind observed:

Saved weather may be stale. Current conditions are not confirmed by this printed guide.

The Companion is decision support, not permission. Weather is evidence, not permission. Actual sky, wind, terrain, access, pace, descent requirements, and group condition govern field decisions.